

BEST ADVICE

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Mercedes-Benz India is the local subsidiary of the German luxury automobile manufacturer



What was the problem you were grappling with?

In the past, I used to be very restless and make snap judgements. This made many of my colleagues feel like they weren't part of the solution we had set out to achieve, especially when venturing into uncharted territory in business.

Whom did you approach for advice and why?

I approached my former boss, Martin Schwenk, who was managing director and CEO of Mercedes-Benz India between 2018 and 2022. With Martin at the helm, we were spearheading the launch of 'Retail of the Future,' India's first direct-to-consumer business model for an automotive brand. It was a testing time for our leadership prowess, as there were huge expectations from the headquarters and, more importantly, from our team in India.

What was the advice you received?

"If you want to go fast, go alone; if you want to go far, go together," is an old African phrase that Martin advised me to ponder upon. He drove home the importance of community, and how I needed to slow down and take everyone along, even if that meant slowing down the rate of disruption.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

This advice was vital in transforming my leadership style. It stressed the need for pausing to have a broader perspective, especially when you set a considerably higher and steeper objective to achieve. As the Covid-19 pandemic loomed on the horizon, we moved on with the 'Retail of the Future' transition. This piece of advice completely altered my perspective on business. With our workers, franchise partners, and global IT teams, we executed a complex process for the first time in the market. The team was dedicated to improving the 'customer experience' for the brand's long-term prosperity and professional development. We went far with this advice and succeeded! **BT**

—TEAM **BT**

“If you want to go far, go together”

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